Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically at 1:00 p.m. on January 11, 2021

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Present:	Chair - Councillor	A. Khan
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Reports

3.1 Staff Reports

3.1.1 2021 Capital & Operating Budget Workshop

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance / Treasurer, delivered a presentation regarding the upcoming 2021 Operating Budget. D. Valentim provided an overview of the operating budget including process and timelines for development of the budget. D. Valentim discussed budget framework, tax calculation, revenues by source, operating budget development, operating budget impacts, Safe Restart Funding, and operating budget outlook.

Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services / Clerk, provided an update on the Information Technology Strategic Plan. N. Cooper identified ways in which technology is contributing to the 2021 budget, project overview and timelines, delivery of services, and staffing requirements.

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, provided an update regarding the Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) project, including project costs, supports for the program, staffing requirements, and reduced anticipated revenues.
John Grieve, Transportation Supervisor, discussed costs associated with the program,

revenues, and how each contribute to the 2021 budget.

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding the ASE project, percentage of property taxes reflected by residential class, the Library Grant, eliminating Library fines, stabilization reserve transfer and investment returns on reserves, annualization of 2020 approved positions, assessment growth, deficit position, operating budget impacts, and taxation revenues. D. Valentim, G. Romanowski, J. Grieve, Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, Ajax Public Library, and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members. Committee Members requested that the study related to eliminating Library fines and a summary of staff positions filled in 2020 be circulated to Committee Members.

The Committee recessed at 2:13 p.m.

The Committee resumed at 2:20 p.m.

D. Valentim delivered a presentation and overview of the upcoming 2021 Capital Budget and 2022-2025 Long Range Capital Forecast. D. Valentim discussed capital budget funding, the Financial Sustainability Plan, capital reserve allocations, long-term debt, current Studies and Master Plans impacting the capital budget, the Medallion Development, and Asset Management Plan. D. Valentim reviewed the 2021 Draft Capital Budget, including project funding sources, Storm Water Management, and Federal Gas Tax funding details, and concluded the presentation with a review of multi-year/pre-budget approval projects, capital budget highlights, and a summary of next steps in the budget process.

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding debenture interest rates, additional facilities required by the Town, electric vehicle charging stations, Storm Water Management and pressures on the Capital Budget. D. Valentim and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from the Committee.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the 2021 Capital & Operating Budget Workshop presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

4. Adjournment (2:55 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Lee

That the January 11, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

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Chair

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Acting D-Clerk